

Zero To Idea — Contest 1

Finding Your Idea

1. What problem have you personally noticed?

A “silent derailment” happens in lectures — in subjects like physics or calculus, if a student gets lost on one intermediate step, the next thirty minutes of class feel lost with them. Students freeze, stop absorbing the material, and mentally check out, because pausing a thirty-person room to ask a question feels too awkward.

2. Who else has this problem? How do you know?

I surveyed nineteen classmates across math and science sections: seventeen said that once they lose track of a concept mid-lecture, they stop trying to understand and switch to mindless note-copying. I also talked to two teachers, and both named the same challenge — the “stare wall” — they can't tell if silence means mastery or confusion until quiz day.

3. What do people currently do to deal with this problem, and why isn't it good enough?

Interrupting live triggers social anxiety and breaks the class's momentum, so almost nobody does it. Rewatching lectures or searching YouTube at night burns forty minutes just to find the ten-second clarification that should have happened in the moment. And copying homework solvers like Photomath or generic AI gives derivations without diagnosing the specific logical misconception that caused the confusion in class.

4. What is one possible idea to solve it?

NudgePoint — a zero-login, browser-based pulse tool for classrooms. Students scan a QR code on the board that gives their phone a single passive button: “Lost Here.” If more than 15% of the class taps it within a 90-second window, a subtle amber pulse appears on the teacher's podium display. It signals a comprehension drop, letting the teacher pause and re-explain the last step naturally, without identifying or embarrassing anyone.

5. Why do you think this idea could be viable?

Teachers want instant pacing feedback without the silence of asking “Does everyone get this?”, while students need an anxiety-free way to signal friction. Unlike enterprise education platforms that need district budgets, IT approvals, and student logins, NudgePoint runs entirely in a lightweight web tab in ten seconds — giving immediate value to both sides of the classroom desk from day one.